

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT PROCESSES

Lab Sheet 1 – Stakeholders

INTRODUCTION

Throughout the unit, you will be working on a *case study*, which is a detailed (fictional) scenario that we are going to use to apply the knowledge you're learning on the unit. When the time comes for assessment, you will be working on a second case study, applying the knowledge again – to a new problem. Most weeks, these sessions will involve figuring out how you would go about actually doing the things talked about in lectures in the case study scenario. The tasks will mainly be discussion-based, with time set aside to talk with the people sat around you, followed by a class-wide discussion for everyone to share their ideas.

TASK 1: FAMILIARISING YOURSELF WITH THE CASE STUDY

It would be worthwhile to spend the first 20-30 minutes of the session reading through the case study and imagining how you might go about handling this project if you were put in charge of it *right now*. You might be nervous, you might feel underprepared. Both are OK. In industry, it is not at all uncommon to be put in charge of something that you don't even feel you fully understand at the outset. You often don't fully understand what people want from you until you've pitched them some ideas and they've had a chance to make revisions.

Over the course of the unit, you will learn a number of techniques commonly used in industry to manage projects, or used when working on parts of a software project. Not all of them will be helpful in every scenario, you'll see that some are a better fit than others to the problem at hand.

TASK 2: IDENTIFYING STAKEHOLDERS

In the lecture, we discussed the concept of project stakeholders. These are people or groups of people who have some specific *interest* in the system. Identifying stakeholders can be a tricky business, and missing stakeholders out early in the project can doom it to eventual failure. In this task, you are going to identify as many of the stakeholders in the case study as possible, making a note of each of the stakeholders you find, and a note of what their interest in the system is.

In the lecture, we looked at some common categories of system stakeholders. These categories make a good starting point for your search, so they are reproduced below:

- They might use the system
- They might be paying for the system
- They might regulate the system's use
- They might be affected by the system

With the people sat around you, try to create a list covering as many of the stakeholders as you can find. For each of those identified, make a note of their interest in the system. Why do they care about the system? What do they want from it?

TASK 3: CLASS DISCUSSION

Your lab tutor will gather everyone together with time before the end of the lab session to go through the stakeholders that everybody has found. See if other people came up with the same as you. Did you miss any? Did you think of stakeholders that everybody else missed? Did people generally agree on what each different stakeholder's interests were?

Keep notes of the discussion and make sure you finish the session with a finalised list of stakeholders for the scenario in the case study. You will need them for future weeks.